

automatically invoke our equivalent of the andon cord.

When our immune system detects a problem, a number of things happen immediately:

1. The defective change is removed immediately and automatically.
2. Everyone on the relevant team is notified of the problem.
3. The team is blocked from introducing any further changes, preventing the problem from being compounded by future mistakes ...
4. ... until the root cause of the problem is found and fixed. (This root cause analysis is discussed in greater detail in [Chapter 11](#).)

At IMVU, we called this continuous deployment, and even in the fast-moving world of software development it is still considered controversial.³ As the Lean Startup movement has gained traction, it has come to be embraced by more and more startups, even those that operate mission-critical applications. Among the most cutting edge examples is Wealthfront, whose pivot was described in [Chapter 8](#). The company practices true continuous deployment—including more than a dozen releases to customers every day—in an SEC-regulated environment.⁴

Continuous Deployment Beyond Software

When I tell this story to people who work in a slower-moving industry, they think I am describing something futuristic. But increasingly, more and more industries are seeing their design process accelerated by the same underlying forces that make this kind of rapid iteration possible in the software industry. There are three ways in which this is happening:

1. Hardware becoming software. Think about what has happened in consumer electronics. The latest phones and tablet computers are